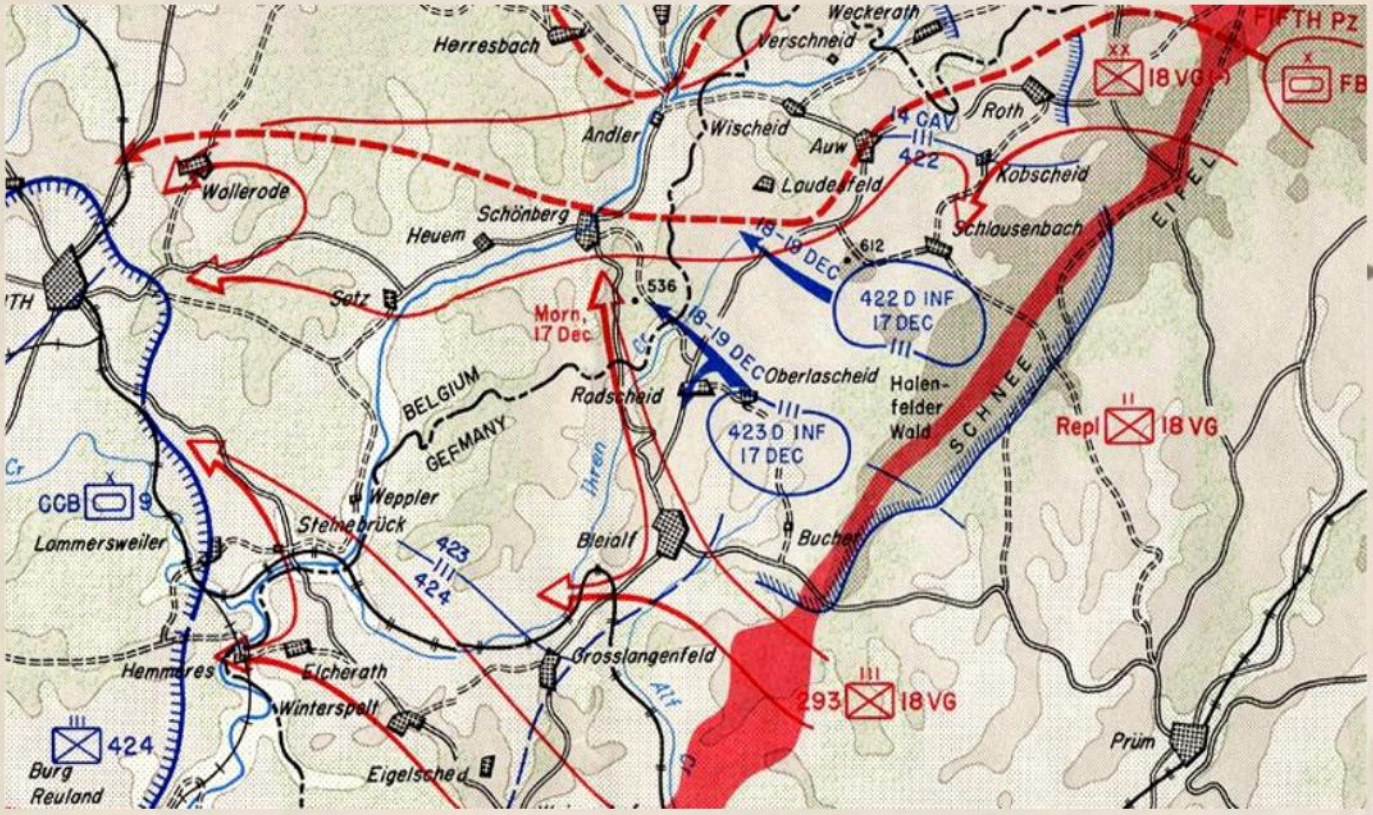
HEROES OF NORMANDIE

Schnee Eifel '44

The Tragedy of the 106th US Infantry Division

16-19 December 1944



1) Historical Introduction:

The 106th US Infantry Division was born on March 15, 1943 in Fort Jackson, South Carolina. It is formed around the small experienced core of the 80th division to accept the mass of conscripts who will integrate into the new formation. The 106th is entrusted to Major General Alan Jones.

The training begins at the end of March 1943 and lasts until January 1944. The division reaches the highest possible stage of preparation. The 106th is then transferred to Indiana at Camp Atterbury. In order to replace the ranks of other weakened units the division loses 60% of its best elements. She will not recover. In return, it receives completely inexperienced new recruits. The training resumes and in September the division receives its transfer order to Europe. After a passage through England, the 106th landed in Le Havre at the beginning of December 1944.

Mission orders arrive on December 6th. The 106th is assigned to the VIII US Army Corps and heads to the St Vith area of Belgium where she is to take over for the US 2nd Infantry Division. The transfer will take two long days and many soldiers will suffer from the cold. According to the orders of the General Middleton (Commander of the VIII Corps), the "Golden Lions" must replace the 2nd Infantry Division, man for man, canon for canon. The switchover will take until December 11th. In the process the 2nd Infantry Division will replace missing equipment (including radio and telephone) using the 106th stocks. ***"You will not need it here, the place is quiet,"*** the veterans of the "Indian Head" division tell them. It is true that the Ardennes in 1944 is a relatively "calm" front. The terrain is inhospitable and in the minds of Americans, the Germans are "screwed up". The Ardennes is therefore an ideal place for a green division to "learn war".

Nevertheless General Jones has some concerns. The front of the 106th is spread out over 35 km. Normally the division should have had a front of 8 km maximum. In addition, links with neighboring divisions are held by the 14th Cavalry Group, a reconnaissance unit that is not adapted to occupy a static position. But it was not a concern because the area was considered calm. Starting December 14, funny noises were heard in the German lines. Captured deserters mentioned rumors of a nearby attack. The tension was rising, but if the high command said that there was no need to worry, they must be right.

But opposite them is no longer the few German units from autumn but 3 armies containing 300,000 men and 1,900 tanks. Hitler has decided to launch his last-chance offensive towards Antwerp. In front of the 106th front stands the LXVII Armee Korps. This corps consists of the 18 and 62 Volksgrenadier Divisions. The 62 VGD of Oberst Friedrich Kittel must attack between the 106th's 423rd and 424th Regiment. The 18 VGD of General Major Gunther Hoffman-Schonborn is to wrap around the 2 regiments of the 106th deployed forward in the Schnee Eifel.

The objective of these two divisions is to clear the road network in the center of the Ardennes in support of 5 and 6SS Panzerarmees. The timing is very tight. St Vith must be taken by the evening of December 17th or at the latest by the morning of the 18th.



2) Campaign Victory Conditions:

Each scenario won awards 3 CVPs (Campaign Victory Points) to its winner. A draw awards 1 CVP to each player. The player with the most "classic" victory points scores 1 CVP Bonus. At the end of the campaign scenarios, the player with the most CVP wins the campaign.

The loser of the previous scenario draws at random a tactical bonus that he can store (maximum 2) or use for a future scenario of the campaign.



2) Game Modes:

Players can play "Schnee Eifel 44" in 2 ways:

a) The complete set of scenarios
b) The scenarios of a chapter of your choice



3) Special Rules:



The following special rules apply for all campaign scenarios.

4) Weather :

The weather in December 1944 was unique.

Unless otherwise indicated the weather is "Fog" for all scenarios.

The maximum range of any fire is **5 spaces**. Beyond this distance it is impossible to fire.

The long range penalty begins at **3 spaces**.

To locate a unit in ambush mode in a scenery element, you must be adjacent to it.

A unit may be in ambush mode in open terrain (outside a scenery element) if no enemy is present within **3 spaces** or less with an **LOS** to the ambushing unit.

In direct fire scattering is increased by 1 space. The range of indirect fire is not changed.

5) Wheat Fields:

The wheat fields do not exist.
At this time they have already been harvested.



6) American Recruitment Tiles:

All American recruitment tiles and heroes in "Schnee Eifel 44" are considered to be part of the 106th US Infantry Division and its attached units. They are therefore considered to have the division symbol to the right instead of the original symbol.



7) German Reqruitment Tiles

All German tiles and heroes in "Schnee Eifel 44" are considered to be part of the 18 Volksgrenadier Division and its attached units. They are therefore considered to have the division symbol to the right instead of the original symbol.





8) "Concealed" Option

In any scenario where the "concealed" option is used, its owner can use it as soon as it is deployed.

Very useful for camouflaging an antitank gun that can be betrayed by the size of its counter.

9) Secondary Objectives:

Secondary objectives are not removed after control. The presence of a unit is not necessary to maintain control.



10) Tank Riders

This option grants each heavy vehicle in the recruiting tile a limited transport capacity.

Any vehicle carrying "riders" can not cross a grove, forest, ruins, water zones and defensive positions. If a vehicle enters one of these spaces the "riders" must jump to the ground (bail out)

"Riders" can shoot but with a combat bonus of 0. If their bonus was "X" this remains "X"

"Riders" are vulnerable to enemy fire. Their defense values are decreased by 1.

Special ambush ability can not be used by **"Riders"**

Heavy weapons units (red border) must be on their moving side if they are **"Riders"**

"Bail out": If the vehicle enters a prohibited space and the vehicle carrying them is destroyed, or they are the target of a shot, the **"Riders"** must **"Bail out".** Place the **"Riders"** on a square adjacent to the vehicle carrying them and place on them 1 suppressed marker.



11) Chapter 1 : 16 December 1944, The Attack

1-A : Brutal awakening for the Golden Lions
1-B : The submerged riders
1-C : We must take Bleialf
1-D : Fall of Auw
1-E : It heats up for gunners



12) Chapter 2 : 17 December 1944, The Envelopment

2-A Fighting withdrawal
2-B A marauding Tiger
2-C Clash at Auw
2-D The end of Battery B
2-E Last stand before St Vith
2-F Defense of "Prumerberg"



13) Chapter 3 : 18 December 1944, The Encirclement

3-A : Confusion on the Skyline Drive.

14) Chapter 4 : 19 December 1944, The End

4-A : The attack of the 3/423rd Inf. Regiment
4-B : The end of the 1/423rd Infantry Regiment
4-C : The ravine of death
4-D : The attack of the 2/422nd Inf. Regiment
4-E : Last stand



15) Necessary Material:

Base Box
St Mere-Eglise Scenario Pack
Carentan Scenario Pack
Pegasus Bridge Scenario Pack
D-Day
US Army Box
GE Army Box
US & GE Extra Vehicles
D-Day Scenario pack
Battleground set
Gazette #1 and 4
British Army Box
River set
Promotional Heroes
GE 21 panzer reinforcements

16) Orders of Battle

Allies:

106th Infantry Division

422nd Infantry Regiment
423rd Infantry Regiment
424th Infantry Regiment
589th Field Artillery Battalion (105mm)
590th Field Artillery Battalion (105mm)
591st Field Artillery Battalion (105mm)
592nd Field Artillery Battalion (155mm)
81st Combat Engineer Battalion
331st Medical Battalion
106th Division HQ Company
106th Division Signal Company
106th Division QM Company
806th Ordnance Company
106th Reconnaissance Troop
106th Military Police Platoon

Attached Units

820th Tank Destroyer Battalion (towed)

German:

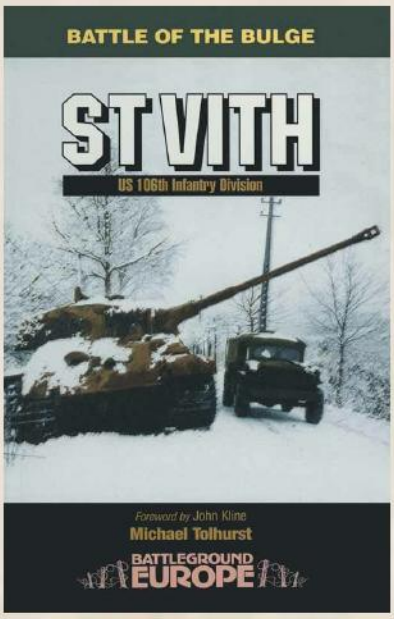
18 Volksgrenadier Division

Volksgrenadier-Regiment 293
Volksgrenadier-Regiment 294
Volksgrenadier-Regiment 295
Volk Artillerie-Regiment 1818
VolksPioneer Battalion 1818
Fusilier Battalion 18
VolksPanzerJager Battalion 1818
VolksFlak Battalion 1818

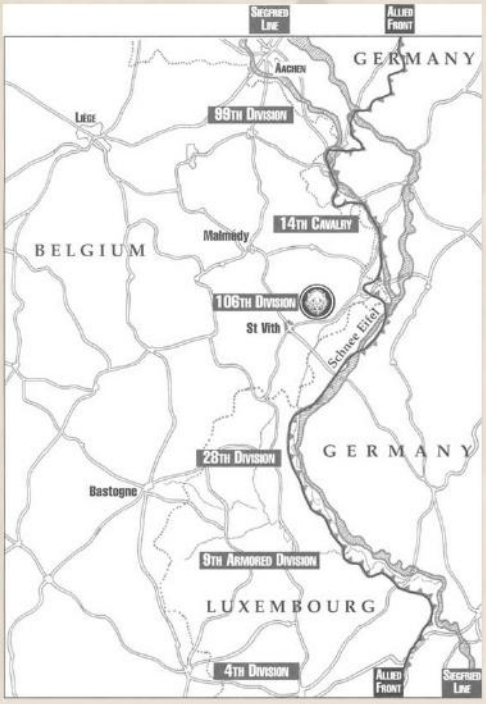
Attached Units

Sturmgeschütz Brigade 244

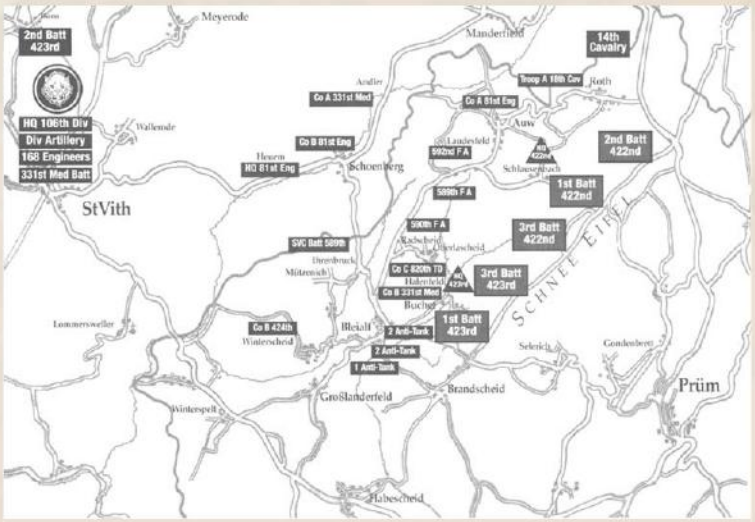
17) Bibliography:



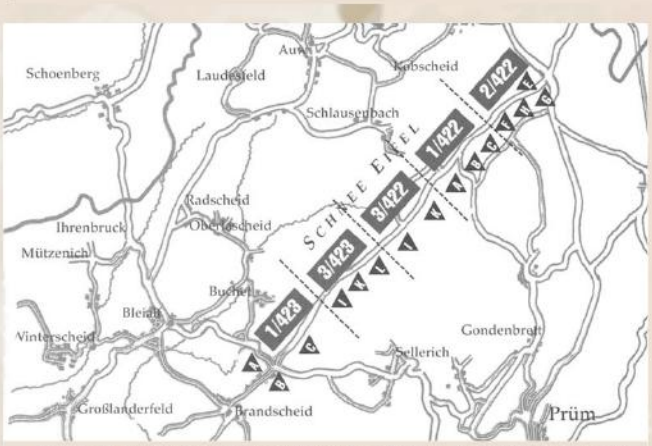
18) Maps:



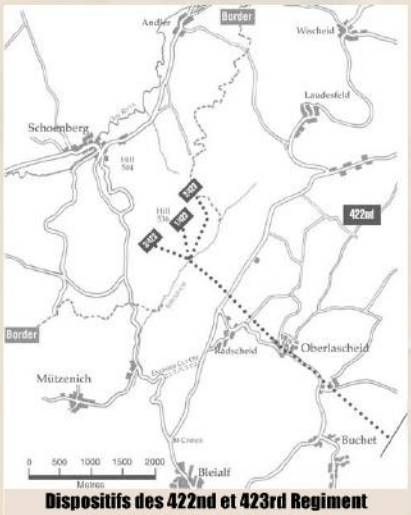
Le Front au 16 Décembre 1944



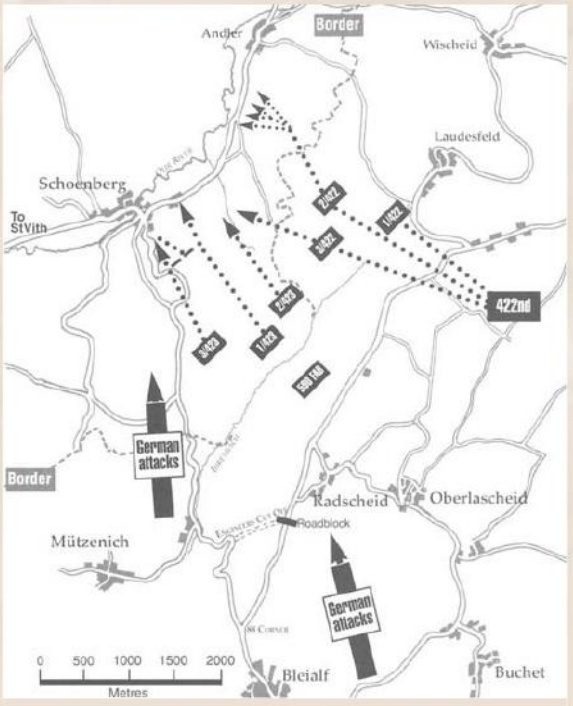
Disposition des unitées dans le Schnee Eifel



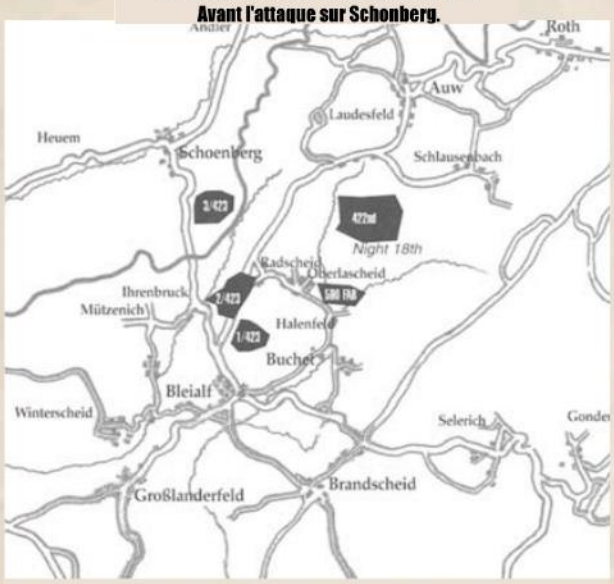
Ligne de Front des compagnies des 422nd et 423rd Regiment



Dispositifs des 422nd et 423rd Regiment
Avant l'attaque sur Schonberg.



L"attaque de la 106th Division le 19/12



Dispositifs des 422nd et 423rd Regiment le 18/12

Thia74 (Pascale Guet) 2016

English translations from the original French by R. Weebe

1-A Brutal awakening for the "*Golden Lions*"



Schlausenbach 16/12/44 06h15: The morning of December 16th the Golden Lions had the most brutal awakening of their existence. German guns of all calibers pounded the front line. The communications were quickly cut off. At his headquarters, Major General Jones was trying to get an idea of what was happening. For the VIII Corps it seemed only a diversionary attack. At 6:15 the barrage stopped. Flares began to appear. The GIs of the 106th saw ghostly forms arising edges of the woods and heard the sounds of treads.

Composition of the Armies

Elements of the *HQ Company, 1/422nd US Infantry Regiment*



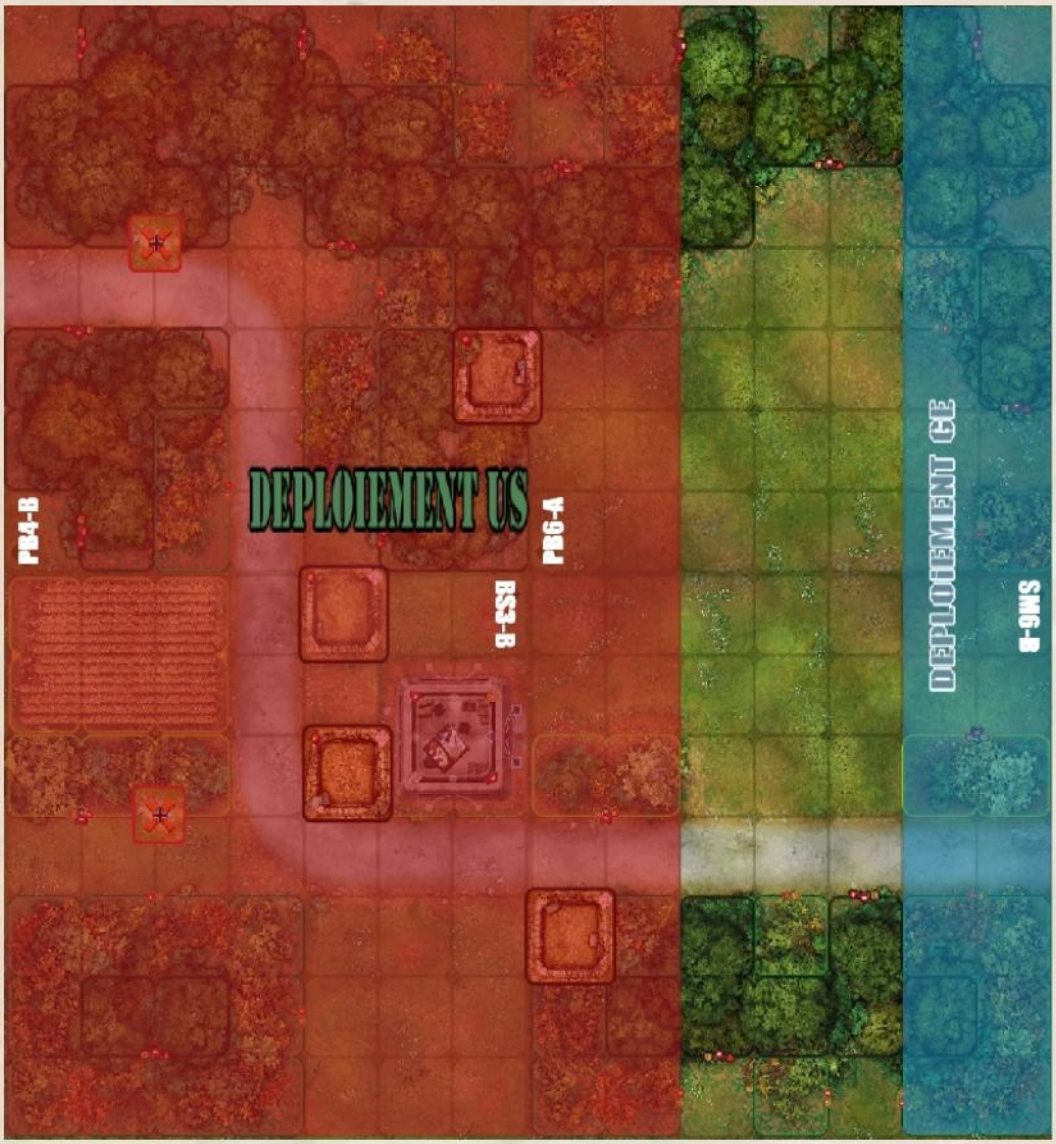


Elements of the *295 Volksgrenadier regiment , 18 Volksgrenadier division*





Battle Map:





Preparation

Remove all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards from American and German decks.

The German player has the initiative and the American player sets up first.

Each player draws **4** cards.

Victory Conditions:

The German player wins if he controls one of the two main objectives at the end of the scenario.

Special Rules:

"Flares" have the same effects in "fog" conditions as during "night" conditions

Epilogue :

At the 1st Battalion HQ of the 422nd Regiment was NCO Anthony J. Marino: ***"I was at the command post sitting at the phone table when crack - crack, two cannons pierced the night. The second shot hit the wall behind which stood a lieutenant and a sergeant. LtCol Kent (commanding 1st Bn) was hit in the head as he was not wearing his helmet. In this fatal December 16, it was impossible to evacuate him to a first aid station where he could have been saved. Sgt Kerski enters the command post shouting, "There are Germans everywhere in the perimeter!""***

Despite the shock, the 422nd and 423rd regiments held on, inflicting significant losses on the Germans. But on their flanks things were not going so well.

1-B The Cavalry is Overrun

Bleialf 16/12/44 06h15: *The southern pincer of the 18. VGD consists of the 293. Volksgrenadier Regiment. Coming from Brandscheid their first goal is the small town of Bleialf on the right flank of the 1/423rd Infantry Regiment. The space between the 423rd and 424th regiment is held by a myriad of small units including 18th Cavalry Squadron troopers.*



Composition of the Armies

Elements of *Troop B, 18th Cavalry Squadron*



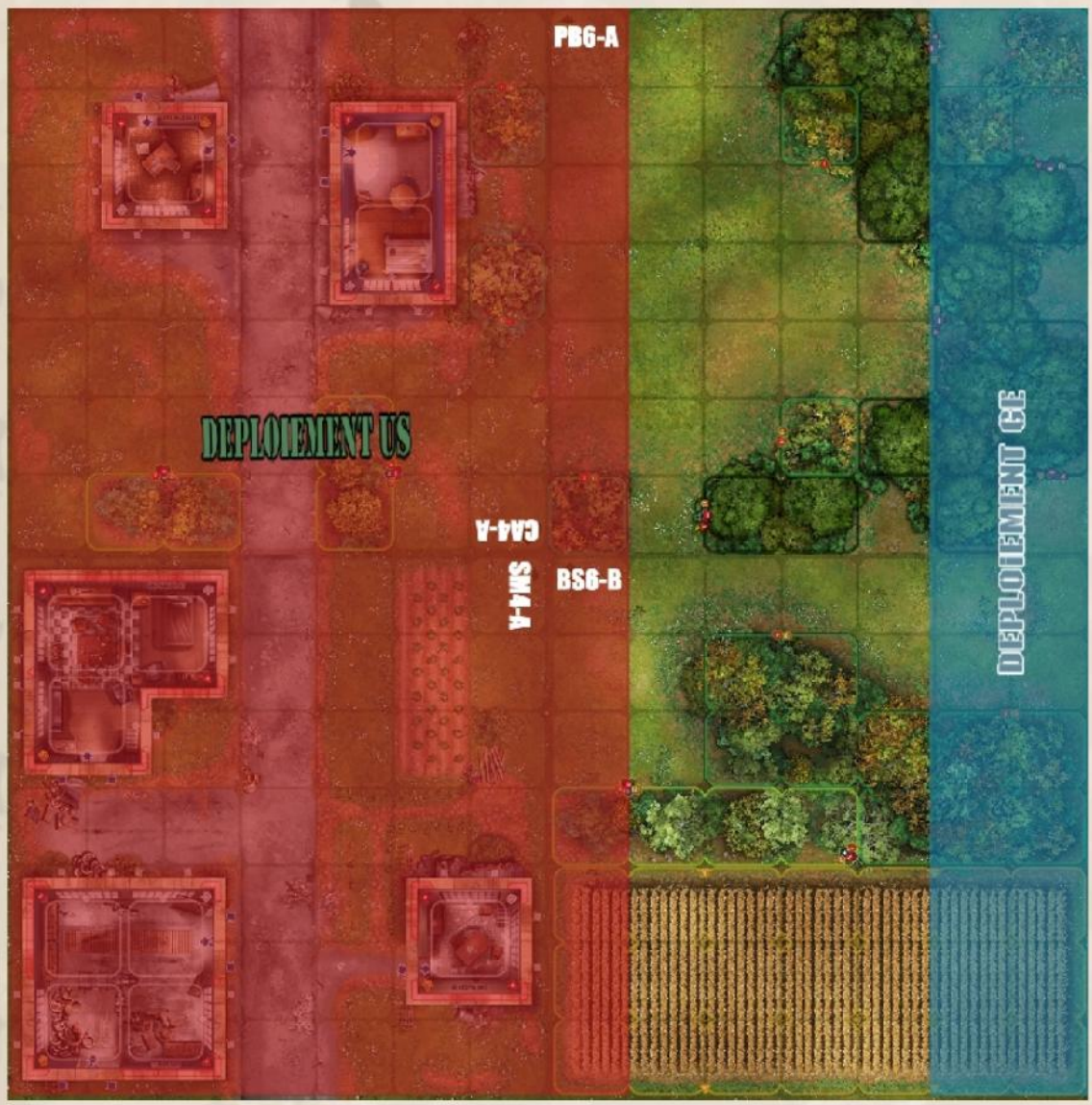


Elements of the *293. Volksgrenadier regiment*, and the *1818. VolksPioneer Battalion*





Battle Map:





Preparation:
Remove all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards from American and German decks.

The German player has the initiative and the American player sets up first.

Each player draws **4** cards.

Victory Conditions:
The German player wins if he controls three buildings at the end of the scenario.

Special Rules:
US *Recon Squadron* units can not use their special deployment capability.

Épilogue:
The Volksgrenadiers arrived in waves and soon reached the railway line southwest of Bleialf. They broke through between the 423rd and the 424th regiment. Assault groups coming out of the woods were quickly into Bleialf overrunning the positions of the cavalry and threatening the communications of the 423rd Regiment.

1-C We Must Take Bleialf!



Bleialf 16/12/44 09h30 : realizing the danger of the situation in Bleialf, Colonel Cavender (423rd Regiment) engages its only reserve force, a company of service based in Halenfeld. He also receives the authorization to engage the B Company of the 81st Combat Engineers. The Captain Reid's composite battalion is also joining take over Bleialf.

Composition of the Armies

Elements of the *B Company, 81st Engineer* and *Captain Reid Composite Battalion*







Elements of the *293. Volksgrenadier regiment*





Battle Map:



Preparation:

Remove all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards from American and German decks.

The American player has the initiative and the American player sets up first.

Each player draws **4** cards.

Victory Conditions:

The American player wins if he controls six of the eight buildings in the German Deployment Area at the end of the scenario.

Special Rules:

Combat Engineers deploy in the US deployment area.

The *Rifle Platoon* enters turn 1 through one or more US entry zones.

Clint comes into play with one of the US formations at the player's choice

Epilogue:

The Engineers, operating as infantry, unloaded from the trucks around Bleialf. With the support of the artillery 590th FAB, the various US groups progressed through the streets in furious fighting, mostly in hand-to-hand combat. At 3:00 pm the Americans had cleared the majority of the city, except for a few houses near the station. Nearly 200 bodies from both sides were found lying in the streets.

1-D Fall of Auw!

Auw 16/12/44 13h00: In the north the 422nd Regiment had its own concerns. The Germans had taken the villages of Krewinkel, Roth, and Kobscheid from the cavalry of the 14th Cavalry Group and was now heading to Auw. This threatened the left flank of the 422nd and the 422nd and 423rd Regiment withdrawal routes. Lt. William J. Coughlin had directed his 1st Platoon to Schlausenbach this morning when he heard artillery fire on Auw. He then turned around and reached the village at the same time as the Germans.



Composition of the Armies

Elements of the *A Company, 81st Engineer*



Elements of the *295. Volksgrenadier regiment*



Battle Map:





Preparation:
Remove all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards from American and German decks.

Determine the initiative randomly. The player with the initiative is placed first.

Each player draws **4** cards.

Victory Conditions:
The player who controls the primary goal and a secondary goal at the end of the scenario wins.

Special Rules:
None.

Epilogue:
Roth having fallen at midday, the Germans were now focusing on their next goal, Auw. The *Engineers* offered fierce resistance despite an unfavorable balance of power. When the German tanks made their appearances, the cause was heard. Most of the A company retreated to Heuem, but one group was trapped in a house with the only escape route being a clear field. *Sgt Withee* decided to stay and cover the flight of his comrades. He fought alone like a lion and it was only when the house was almost destroyed and his comrades in safety that he stopped the fight and surrendered. He was decorated with the *Distinguished Service Cross*.

1-E It Heats up for the Gunners

South of Auw 16/12/44 15h00 : Throughout the morning the 106th Division's artillery battalions supported the 422nd and 423rd Regiment with a steady fire, but it became clear that their positions were now in danger because of the German advance and the fall of Auw.



Composition of the Armies

Elements of the *A Battery, 589th Field Artillery Battalion* and the *HQ 422nd Regiment*









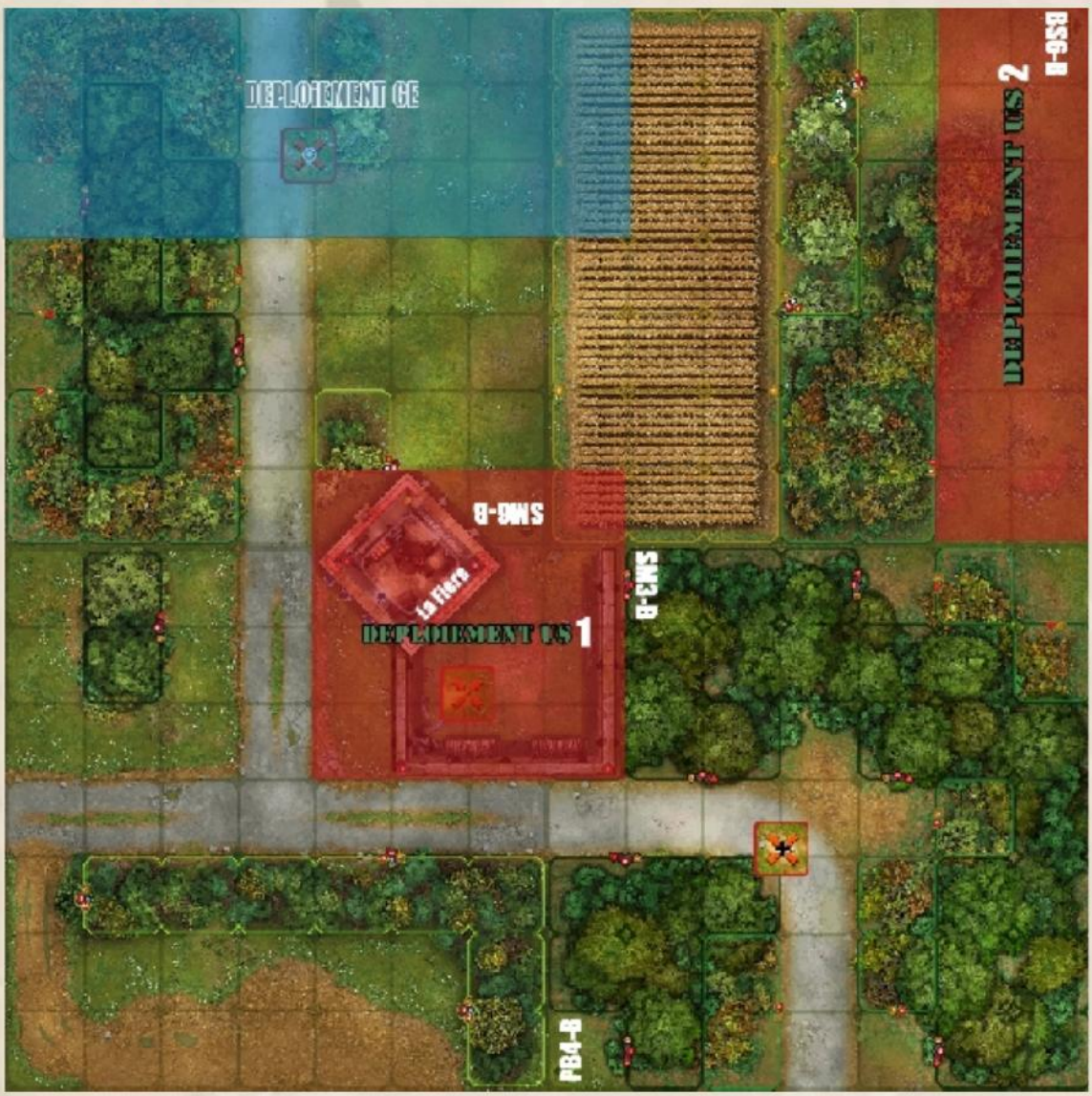
Elements of the *295. Volksgrenadier regiment*







Battle Map:





Preparation:
Remove all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards from American and German decks.

The German player has the initiative and the American player sets up first.

Each player draws **4** cards.

Victory Conditions:
The player who controls the neutral main goal and his specific main goal at the end of the scenario wins.

Special Rules:
The *Weapon Platoon* and *Brady* deploy in the US1 zone.

The *Rifle Platoon* and *Clint* deploy in the US2 zone.

Epilogue:
In the early afternoon, armored vehicles emerged from fog from Auw. Lt. Eric Fisher Wood Jr. was positioned on a hill to get a better view and to direct the fire of a howitzer. The 105mm destroys an assault gun forcing others to take cover. Colonel Descheneaux, realizing the danger, sent a force composed of members of his HQ to ensure the protection of the artillery pending the arrival of reinforcements.

Historically, the 589th Field Artillery Battalion was equipped with a 105mm M2A1 howitzer.

Given the risk to his artillery, Major General Jones decided to limber the 589th and 592nd Artillery. At Schönberg, 2/423rd of LtCol Puett, 106th Division Reserve Battalion is dispatched to cover the artillery withdrawal and the flank of the 422nd Regiment. Nevertheless, there was good news. Combat Command B of the 9th US Armored Division was en route to lend a hand.

Finally Major General Jones received a call from General Middleton in Bastogne. Both officers thought the line could be spied on. This resulted in an awkward conversation and the two parties did not get to understand each other. In the end Jones was convinced that he had to keep his two regiments in place and that Middelton would send him the 7th US Armored Division the next day to Schönberg.

As a result he canceled the 9th Armored CCB's movement orders and sent them in support of the 424th Regiment further south. However, for some of Jones' entourage it was clear that it was impossible for the 7th Armored to travel the 100 km separating it from the 422nd and 423rd Regiment in one night.

The 2/423rd reached artillery positions around midnight, while the 589th and 592th Field Artillery were in full readiness for retreat. Descheneaux moved his left battalion to face north. To the south, the 423rd had taken over Bleialf but contact with the 424th had been lost.

The 106th did not lose too much ground on December 16th and still held the Schnee Eifel. If the Germans wanted to keep their schedule, Schönberg had to be taken on the morning of December 17th.





2-A Fighting Withdrawal

Bleialf 17/12/44 06h00: During the night of the 16th to the 17th of December, the Germans plunged into the gap of Losheim, now wide open. The 14th Cavalry group was desperately trying to form a line of defense. At 00:36, General Jones received from the headquarters of the VIII Corps the following order: "The troops must withdraw only if the position becomes untenable". The defenders of Bleialf learned from a prisoner that the Germans would launch an action to retake the village. Colonel Cavender forwarded the information to the division. Patrols confirmed the threat when they saw the German preparations.



Composition of the Armies

Elements of the *B Company, 81st Engineer* and the *Captain Reid Composite Battalion*







Éléments of the *293. Volksgrenadier regiment*, 18. *Volksgrenadier division*





Battle Map





Preparation:

Remove all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards from American and German decks.

The German player has the initiative and the American player sets up first.

Each player draws **4** cards.

Victory Conditions:

The player who controls the main objective at the end of the scenario wins. At the beginning of the game it is not controlled by anyone.

Special Rules:

The American player can replace one of his cards with the "Opportunitistic Fire" card

Epilogue:

After a preparation of artillery, the Germans launch the assault at 06:00 rising from a railway tunnel. They rush into the village forcing the defenders to disperse. Engineers are immediately overrun. The rest of the defenders retreat while fighting on Buchet and the positions of the 423rd Regiment. With the fierce resistance of the Americans finally broken, the 293. Volksgrenadier Regiment now presses its advance along the "Skyline Drive" towards Schönberg.

2-B A Marauding Tiger

Andler 16/09/44 07h30: At 6:30 Captain Lynsey received orders from the 32nd Squadron to send reconnaissance to Auw to establish contact with the Germans. At 7:20 Sgt Turner transmits the following message *"The enemy has surrounded us!"*. Facing the the power of the Germans, Captain Linsey gets permission to retreat to Schönberg.



Composition of the Armies

Elements of *Troop B, 32nd Cavalry Squadron*









Eléments of the *295. Volksgrenadier Regiment* and *schwere Panzer-Abteilung 506*









Battle Map:



Preparation:

Remove all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards from American and German decks.

The German player has the initiative and the American player sets up first.

Each player draws **4** cards.

Victory Conditions:

The American player wins if he has at least 3 units in the "B" zone at the end of the scenario.

Special Rules:

US Recon Squadron units can not use their special deployment capability.

The weather is Clear Weather.

The Tiger must exit through hex A before the end of the scenario. If the German player does not do it he automatically loses the game. He can not move off-road.

Epilogue:

The small group of troopers in their armored cars can do nothing against the German surge. Especially since a lost Koenig Tiger of 506 sPzAbt joined the assault. The latter seeking especially to find a route to join his unit. Troopers arriving at Schönberg discover that Bleialf has just fallen. They continue their retreat on Heuem with the Germans on their heels. Fortunately for them, the Tiger changed its route along the way.

Historically the 506 sPzAbt was equipped with the Pz VIb King Tiger

2-C Clash at Auw

Auw 17/09/44 07h00: The 2nd Battalion, 423rd regiment, commanded by LtCol Puett, now occupying the former positions of the 589th Field Arty Bn, sent patrols to Auw. These discovered an enemy concentration in formation. At 0700 three tanks came down the road towards the 2/423rd. Puett's anti-tank guns quickly put them out of action. But this was just a taste.



Composition of the Armies

Elements of the *2/423rd Infantry battalion,* and the *820th Tank destroyer battalion*



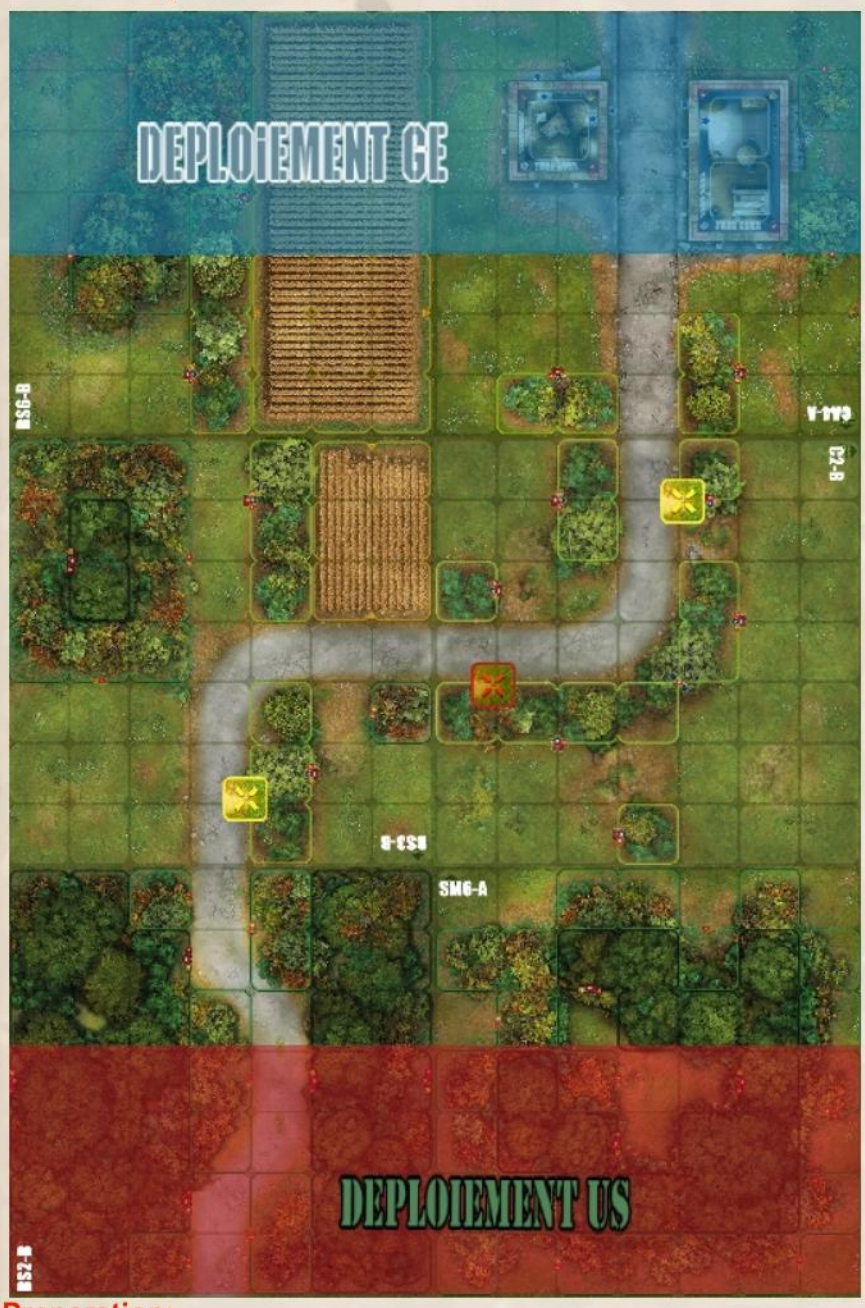


Elements of the *293. Volksgrenadier regiment* and the *Sturmgeschütz-Brigade 244*





Battle Map:





Special Rules:
The US half-track can only carry/ transport the 57mm antitank gun.

Epilogue:
The Germans, more determined than ever, returned to the assault. The tanks were now accompanied by infantry perched on their turrets and decks. Immediately engaged, they were again repulsed by the GIs. The Germans launched the assault again. The 2/423rd having lost contact with the 42nd Regiment, the headquarters of the division could only retreat to Schönberg. Patrols reported to Puett that the Bleialf-Schönberg road was filled with German troops. The only retreat route to avoid encirclement was now cut off.

Historically the 820th TD Bn was equipped with 3 inch (76mm) antitank guns towed by GMC 2,5t Trucks

Preparation:
Remove all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards from American and German decks.

The American has the initiative. Both players place their forces simultaneously. Place a screen between the players for deployment.

Each player draws **4** cards.

Victory Conditions:
The player who controls the primary objective and one of the secondary objectives wins.

2-D Th end of Battery B

Schönberg 17/09/44 08h20: Following numerous communication problems, Colonel Descheneaux of 422nd was not aware of the stalled state of the 589th FAB. At 7:30 it was 5 km from Schönberg when the field battery announced the arrival of German armor 2 km south. Once again it was necessary to harness the howitzers in a hurry. Some pieces had to be abandoned when the German bullets began to whistle. The 589th was now to retreat to St. Vith through Schönberg



Composition of the Armies

Elements of *B Battery, 589th Field Artillery Battalion*



Eléments of the *18. Volksgrenadier division*



Battle Map:



Préparation

Remove all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards from American and German decks.

The American player has the initiative and the American player sets up first.

Each player draws **4** cards.

Victory Conditions:

The American player wins if he manages to exit 5 points off the left edge of the map. Each Vehicle earns 2 points and infantry units 1 point.

Special Rules:

None.

Epilogue:

J. Don Holtzmuller says: ***"We had just entered Schönberg when we saw an assault gun in the middle of the road. We stopped immediately. None of us opened fire, nor did the Germans, whose guns were pointing in the wrong direction. They disappeared into a bend and we lost sight of them. A jeep arrived at the level of our truck. Lt Wood asked us why we stopped. We told him we had just seen a German tank. He told us it was impossible and that it must be a US tank. He climbed into our truck and asked us to hit the road again. After crossing a bridge over the river Our, in the middle of the village, Lt Wood saw a tank. "You see ! It's an American tank!" He looked again, "Hell !!! no it's a German, gas !!!!!!!!!!!!". As we reached his level, the tank fired at us but he missed. Campagna shot at him with the bazooka and scared him off. We then saw other German soldiers. Corporal Knoll stopped the truck and we were able to get out just before it was destroyed."***

Realizing the situation, the American soldiers had no choice but to surrender.

2-E Last Stand before St.Vith!



Heuem 17/09/44 in the morning: LtCol Williams was at the Schönberg HQ when the Germans made their appearance. He had just enough time to send a message to the division before having to evacuate the city, not without having destroyed the HQ while under enemy fire. He reached Heuem where he found personnel and a tank destroyer.

Composition of the Armies

Elements of the *106th Division Signal Company*



Elements of the *18. Volksgrenadier division*



Battle Map:





Preparation:

Remove all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards from American and German decks.

The American player has the initiative and the German player sets up first.

Each player draws **4** cards.

Victory Conditions:

The German player wins if he controls one of the 2 neutral main objectives at the end of the scenario.

Special Rules:

The scenario lasts 12 turns.

The Sherman is replaced by an M10A1 and must be placed in the "US" zone

The Germans are divided into 3 groups. Group 1 deploys on the board in round 1. Group 2 enters turn 2 (and brings an additional order). Group 3 enters turn 3.

The LtCol Rudder unit enters turn 7 in one of the US entry zones.

The Artillery option is available on/after turn 8

Epilogue:

Williams took over the defense of the area and established a road block. The tank destroyer destroyed an enemy tank. Williams noted that the phone lines were still in place and working. He was able to contact the 592nd Field Artillery who could then bombard the area between Heuem and Schönberg with 155mm fire. It was then that VIII Corps intelligence officer Colonel Slayden arrived. The latter wanted to see for himself what was happening. He too took German fire and turned around and joined Williams' group. He reported to the VIII Corps that he was the last man between Schönberg and St. Vith. Throughout the day Williams and Slayden retreated, using delaying actions at each stop, with the Volksgrenadiers on their heels.

2-F Defense of "Prümer Berg"

Prumerberg 17/12/44 in the morning: *At St. Vith General Jones orders LtCol Riggs to defend the city. For this the 168th Engineer is allocated to him in addition to his 81st Battalion. He decides to establish his line of defense two kilometers to the east on a hill called "Prümer Berg". His orders are to hold pending the arrival of CCB of the 7th Armored Division.*



Composition of the Armies

Elements of the *81st* and *168th Combat Engineer Battalion, 106th division* and advanced elements of the *31st Tank Battalion, CCB, 7th Armored division*



Elements of the *18. Volksgrenadier division*



Battle Map:



Preparation:

Remove all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards from American and German decks except the P47 card which is set aside.

The American player has the initiative and the German player sets up first.

Each player draws **4** cards.

Victory Conditions:

The player who controls most of the main objectives at the end of the scenario wins.

Special Rules:

The scenario lasts 10 turns.

The Aviation card automatically placed in the US player's hand on turn 4 is a P47. It does not count against the limit of 4 cards for the US player.

The Sherman comes into play on turn 6.

The US player can place two "Barbed Wire" in his deployment area of the C5-B and DD4-B tiles.

Epilogue:

At 1300, three German armored vehicles supported by infantry appeared against the positions of the 168th Battalion. One of the tanks was destroyed by a bazooka while the rest retreated to cover. A new assault was repulsed an hour later. Riggs managed to establish an overhead radio connection with a P47 on patrol. One of the rare aircraft able to fly despite the bad weather of December 1944. It strafed the German lines several times in a row, inflicting heavy losses. In the late afternoon, the first elements of the 7th Armored Division's CCB arrived and provided critical support to Rigg's engineers.

Meanwhile at St. Vith, Brigadier General Clarke was waiting for the arrival of his CCB. This unit was caught in monstrous traffic jams. Clarke had arrived early and did not know where his unit was. The leading elements were snarled in the columns that retreated before the German advance. Units arriving at St. Vith were immediately directed in an arc to the east to reinforce Prümer Berg's meager line of defense. The artillery was short of ammunition, and they were stuck in the back of the long column of CCB. At midnight the bulk of the 7th Armored CCB was at St Vith. With the 9th Armored CCB and the 424th Regiment, committed to defending St Vith, it became clear to everyone that the 422nd and 423rd would have to fend for themselves to get out of their encirclement.

General Jones was trying to stay calm with his division largely trapped in the Schnee Eifel. He turned to Clarke and said, ***"I have launched my last troops into the battle, I have nothing left, Your Combat Command will have to defend this position, I entrust you with the command of St.Vith."***

But if the Americans were suffering from traffic jams, the Germans suffered much worse. Chaos reigned everywhere; panzer units had to pass the slower horse-drawn units to continue the offensive. The meticulous planning of the offensive began to flounder. The high command wondered why St. Vith had not fallen.





3-A Confusion on the "*Skyline Drive*".

Radscheid 18/12/44 06h00 : General Jones thought that if his two encircled regiments pushed west, they would escape from the encirclement and help destroy enemy units around St. Vith. The order took 2 hours to reach the 423rd. Descheneaux, upon reading the order had these words "***My poor soldiers, they will be cut to pieces!***". The two regiments, despite communication problems, decided to move at dawn. The weather was terrible, fog and rain. The infantrymen had to advance painfully on narrow forest paths. Boyd Rutledge, D Coy / 422nd, "***There was no road and we were advancing through the forest. We reached our attack positions at 1am after 9 hours of walking in the dark. We traveled 20 to 30 km in mud and snow, but actually only 5 km in a straight line. On the 423rd side the 2nd Battalion lead the march followed by the 1st and 3rd following the Halenfeld-Radscheid-Schonberg axis.***



At midday the 2nd Battalion of Ltc Puett had reached the "Skyline Drive" and immediately received enemy fire. Puett directed his battalion to counter the threat."

Composition of the Armies

Elements of the *2/423rd Regiment*













Elements of the *18. Volksgrenadier division*







Battle Maps:



Preparation:

Remove from the American and German decks all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.

The American player has the initiative. Both players deploy simultaneously. Place a screen between the two players. One US "Rifle Platoon" and one German "Grenadier" unit must deploy on each side of the yellow line. The Commander and Hero tiles do not have this restriction.

Each player draws **4** cards.

Victory Conditions:

The US player wins if at the end of the scenario he has more than 10 units advanced past (to the left of) the road. If he's under 8, it's a German victory.

Special Rules:

None.

Epilogue:

The ground offered no cover but the infantry supported by the machine guns and the mortars attacked in order to clear out the "Skyline drive". The Germans who had to defend the open road received regular reinforcements from Bleialf. Puett then called Colonel Cavender to receive reinforcements to maintain his counterattack.



The 1st Battalion was ordered to join the 2nd Battalion but with the arrival of night, it could not reach Puett. Both battalions had to retreat to Oberlascheid. In its counterattack the 2nd Battalion lost 300 men and expended the majority of its ammunition. The wounded had to be left behind with some nurses. A Message was received from the division by Cavender. The 422nd and 423rd should now head straight for Schönberg. There will be no counterattack of the 7th US Armored. The two encircled regiments will have to fend for themselves to reach St. Vith.



4-A The Attack of the 3/423rd Regiment

Schonberg 19/12/44 10h00: As the day was dawning the 3/423rd was leading the regiment. The 590th FAB was standing ready to support them despite the stockpile of ammunition being low. There was no contact with the 422nd on their right. The 3/423rd was responsible for the main attack on Schonberg while the 1st and 2nd Bn were tasked with Hill 504. At 9:00 am, while Cavender held a briefing with his battalion commanders, the Germans fired an artillery barrage at the positions of the 423rd. The barrage created a huge mess in the US ranks. LcL Craig from 1st Bn was killed. Then shots and cries were heard in the rear area. The Germans were attacking the positions of 590th FAB! For the 3/423rd LcL Klinck, there was only one option, full attack without retreat. The order was given to destroy the last vehicles of the battalion.



Composition of the Armies

Elements of the 3/423rd Infantry Regiment and the 590th Field Artillery Battalion











Elements of the 18 Volksgrenadier division







1





2

Battle Maps:



PREPARATION

Remove from the American and German decks all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.

The American player has the initiative and the German player deploys 1st.

Each player draws **4** cards.

Victory Conditions:

The player who controls the majority of the primary objectives at the end of the scenario wins.

Special Rules:

Before the start of the game the American player rolls one die for each unit. On a result of 5 or 6 the unit takes a "suppressed" marker.

Americans suffer from a lack of ammunition. Apply a -1 penalty on each shot. Exception: 75mm and assaults.

Brady can direct 75mm firing from any distance as long as he has an order to do so. Mark the 75mm with an Activated marker. The shot is subject to scatter with the Brady bonus.

The German group No. 1 deploys on the map. Group 2 enters turn 2 through the entry zone "GE". The orders for each German group are specific and can not be shared.

Epilogue:

At 10:00 the battalion advanced from its positions towards the Schonberg road. Despite the support of the machine guns of Company M, Company L was taken under German artillery fire. Snipers were wreaking havoc in the US ranks. The Americans then had to face the Flak cannons used in a ground support role. The battalion was then attacked from the rear rear by the Germans who had overrun the 590th FAB. With about forty GIs, Captain Huyatt managed to repel them but was cut off from the rest of the battalion. At 13:30, short of ammunition the survivors of the Company L had to surrender. Meanwhile companies I and K reached the edge of Schonberg but were stopped by the fierce German defense. At 15:00 Lcl Klinck had to retreat the rest of his battalion to Hill 504.





4-B The End of the 1/423rd Infantry Regiment

Schonberg 19/09/44 14h00: Participation in the 1/423rd attack was compromised from the start. The commander was killed during the morning briefing. Major Cosby was charged with leading the attack. But the battalion was in a bad state, Company A was lost the day before at Oberlascheid, Company D was disabled during the morning barrages, and Company C was in reserve of the regiment. Cosby had only company B and part of the battalion headquarters.



Composition of the Armies

Elements of the B Company, 1/423rd Infantry Regiment









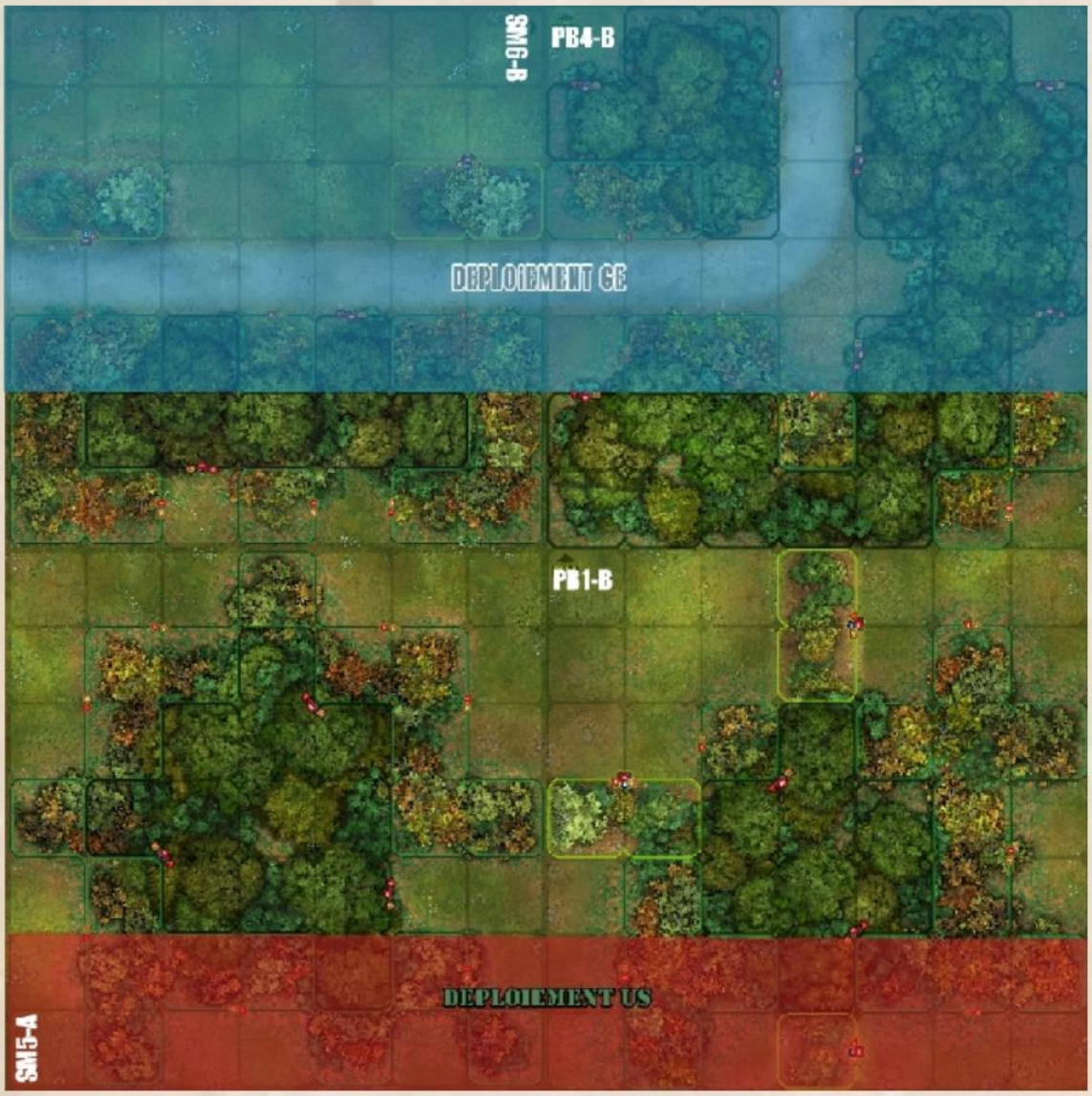
Elements of the 18. Volksgrenadier Division







Battle Map:





PREPARATION

Remove from the American and German decks all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.

The American player has the initiative and deploys 1st.

Each player draws **4** cards.

Victory Conditions:

The American player wins if he has at least 4 units north of the road at the end of the scenario.

Special Rules:

Americans suffer from a lack of ammunition. Apply a -1 penalty on each shot. Exception for assaults.

Epilogue:

Despite its small numbers the 1/423rd attacked east of Hill 504 through very dense forests. Under constant shelling from German mortars, company B, separated from the elements of the headquarters, reached the Schonberg road. But, under the increasingly effective fire of the Germans, and short of ammunition, the remains of the 1/423rd had to surrender when the German tanks overran their positions.

4-C The Ravine of Death

Laudefeld 19/12/44 07h30: Joined by the 2/423rd, which was cut off from the rest of its regiment, the 422nd Regiment left its bivouac areas around 7:30. The 1st Battalion was charged with the right flank. Following the death of LcL Kent, it was now led by Major W. P Moon.



Composition of the Armies

Elements of the C Company 1/422nd Infantry Regiment









Elements of the 18 Volksgrenadier division









Battle Map:



PREPARATION

Remove from the American and German decks all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.

The German player has the initiative and deploys 1st.

Each player draws **4** cards.

Victory Conditions:

The player who controls the primary objective and a secondary objective at the end of the scenario wins. Secondary objectives are not removed after checking.

Special Rules:

The German player must divide his troops into two groups. Each group must contain at least 3 units. One group enters through the left map edge and the second through the right map edge.

The river is considered "dry" and therefore as clear ground. It is only possible to leave the river by the boxes "A" and "B"

US "Recon" can use their special deployment ability, but only in the river.

Epilogue:

The battalion was attacked from the start by armored vehicles supported by enemy infantry. Companies A and B could not even leave their staging areas, immediately pinned down by German firepower. The majority of the 1/422nd was stuck in a ravine with the Germans at each end. Only a platoon of company C could get out of the deadly trap. Anthony Marino of HQ: ***"Our battalion did not have heavy weapons apart from bazookas, and ammunition was scarce. Once the munitions were exhausted, the companies stopped firing. Suddenly a cry was heard "surrender!" The Germans stopped their shots. Captain Mohne told me to destroy my weapon. I then joined the rest of the battalion surrender"***.

4-D The Attack of the 2/422nd Infantry Regiment

Schonberg 19/12/44 07h00: On the left of the 1st Batallion, the 2/422nd managed to cross the Skyline Drive in relatively good order, despite some sudden shooting at the time of departure. The advance continued, reaching a position overlooking the Schonberg-Andler road. There they could observe an impressive spectacle: bumper to bumper, stretched the columns of the Furher Begleit Brigade heading towards St. Vith via Schonberg.



Composition of the Armies

Elements of the 2/422nd Infantry Regiment











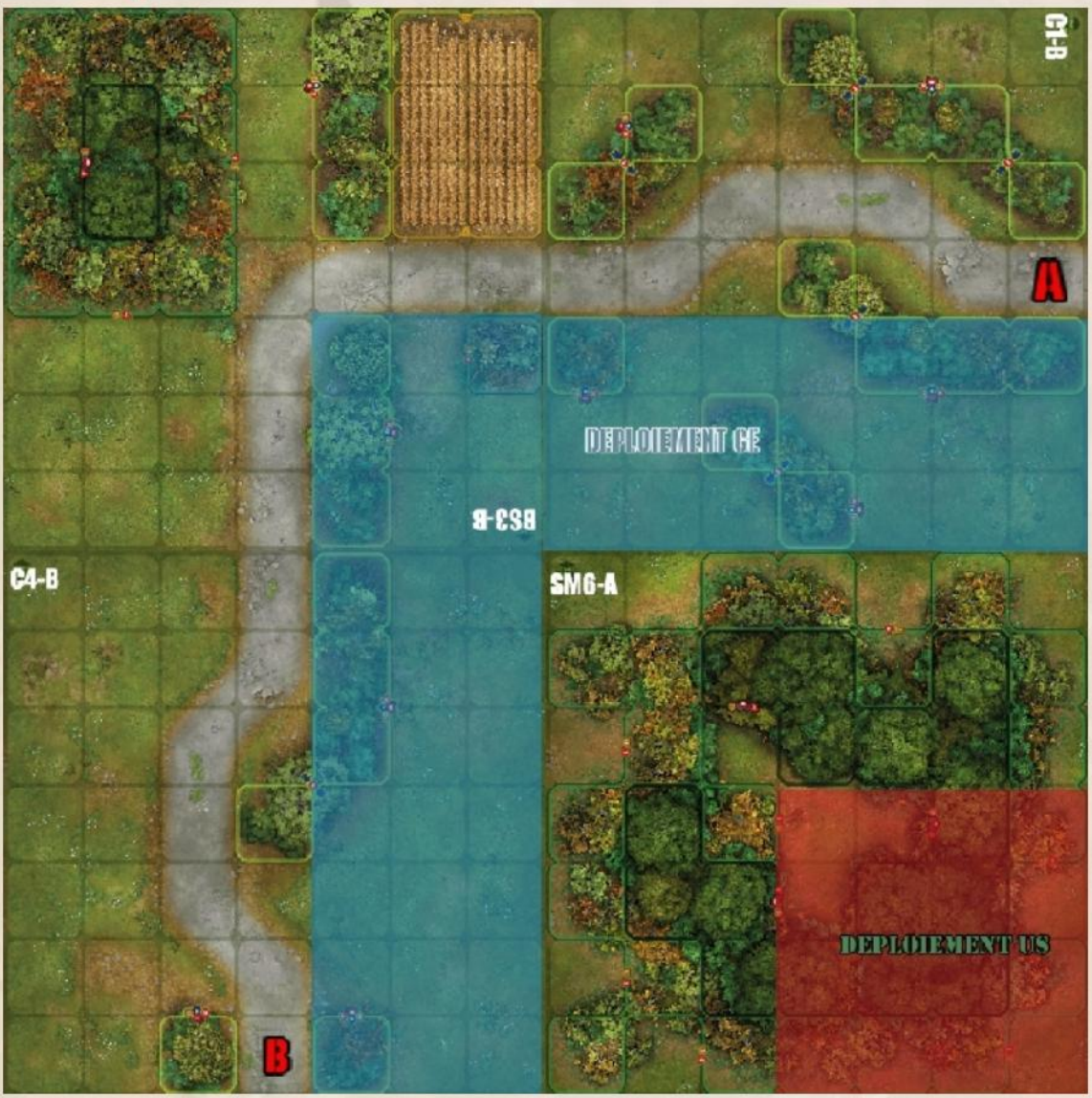
Elements of the Fuhrer Begleit Brigade







Battle Maps:





PREPARATION

Remove from the American and German decks all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.

The American player has the initiative and deploys 1st.

Each player draws **4** cards.

Victory Conditions:

The American player wins if he has destroyed 4 German vehicles by the end of the scenario. Vehicles exited by box "B" (only, not "A") are not considered destroyed.

Special Rules:

The US player cannot use the special ability to deploy recon units.

Apart from the sentinel units all German units deploy on the road adjacent to each other, the infantry units as passengers of the vehicles. Sentinel units are deployed in the German zone. Passengers cannot leave the vehicles until a US shot has been fired.

Due to traffic jams, German vehicles have only 3 movement points.

Epilogue:

The GIs initially thought they were vehicles from the 423rd. But spotted by vigilant sentinels, the Germans blasted the US positions with Flak cannons mounted on halftracks. Despite a response of the mortars of company M, the 2/422nd could not hold its positions and had to fall back into the woods.

4-E Last Stand



Laudesfeld 19/12/44 in the night: After the failure of the 422nd and 423rd regiment attacks, and being unable to move, Colonel Descheneaux tried to form a semblance of a defensive perimeter with the surviving troops. He realized that the situation was hopeless. Without ammunition and without provisions, he gave the surrender order to his regiment at 16:00. Half an hour later Colonel Cavender did the same with his 423rd Regiment. However, some tried to join the American lines anyway. Lt Walker and Major Ouellette managed to gather 500 survivors. Alas, this group did not go unnoticed by the Germans.

Composition of the Armies

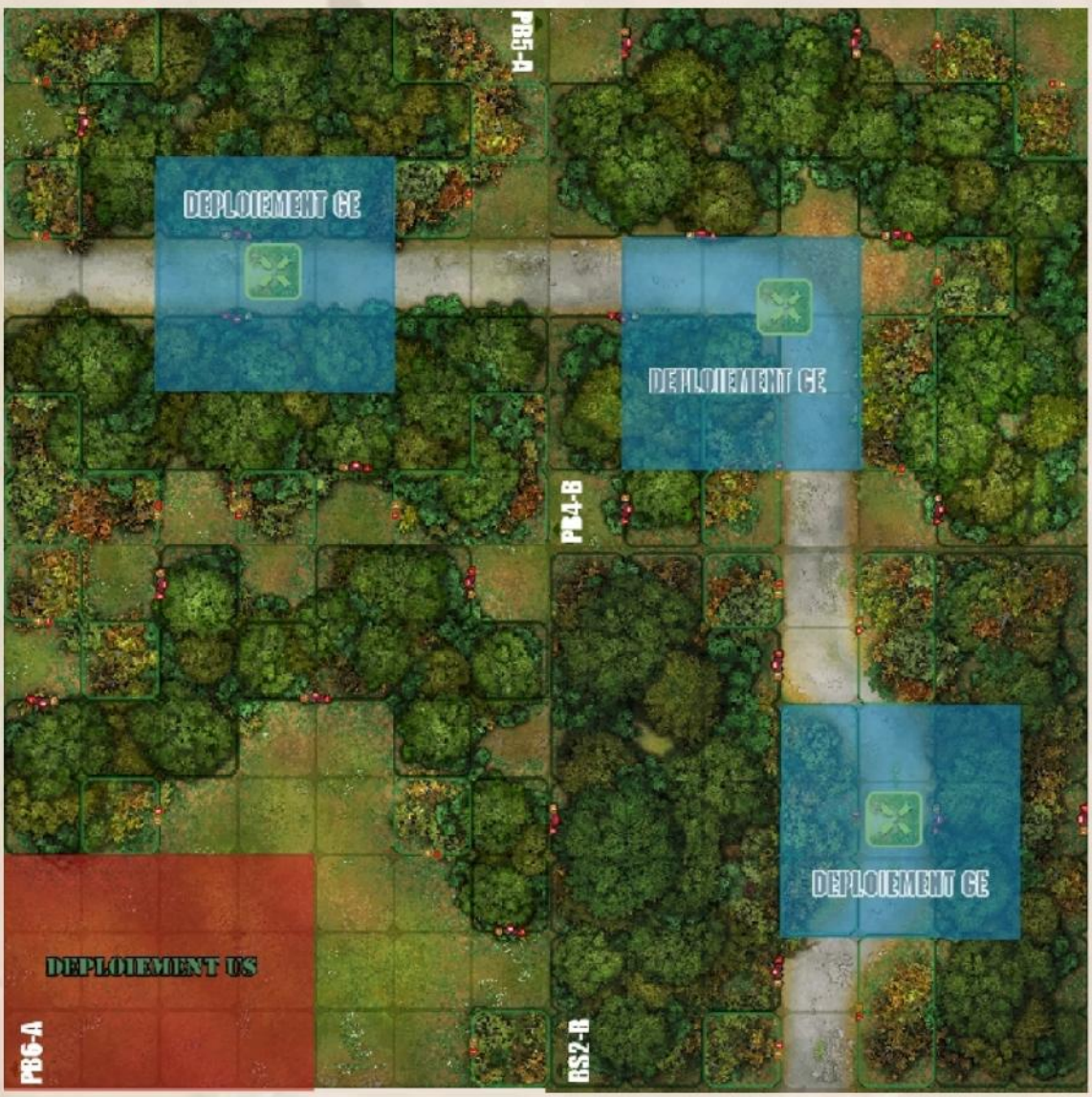
Patrol of Staff Sergeant Richard Thomas, 106th Infantry Division



Elements of the 18 Volksgrenadier division



Battle Maps:





PREPARATION

Remove from the American and German decks all **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.

The American player has the initiative and the German player deploys 1st.

Each player draws **4** cards.

Victory Conditions:

The American player wins if he destroys the Opel Blitz before the end of the scenario.

Special Rules:

The German player must deploy his troops in 3 groups of at least 3 units each.

The Opel Blitz must deploy on a secondary objective and cannot move throughout the scenario. Contrary to the rules, for this scenario the opel Blitz can use "concealed" to camouflage itself. Marker A or B must be used to hide the front box of the truck.

The conditions are "**Dark Night**"

Epilogue:

The Germans welcomed the survivors of the 106th with artillery and music! A propaganda truck was playing American music interspersed with a call for surrender. Once night fell Staff Sergeant Richard Thomas was unable to gather a group of volunteers to silence the truck with grenades.

Conclusion:

December 20th, the Germans sent an ultimatum to the last survivors telling them to surrender. As it was futile and useless to resist against the German power encircling them, Major Ouellette agreed to surrender the next morning at 08:00. He wanted to give some rest to his troops before a long captivity. Although the Germans needed units on the front, they accepted the American proposal.

On 21 December, after destroying their weapons and vehicles, the last soldiers of the 422nd and 423rd Regiment went into captivity. Some men did manage to join the US lines near St Vith, including Lt Long and his Intelligence and Reconnaissance Platoon. Having been separated from his unit, Long and his 40 men, hiding by day and walking at night, joined the St Vith salient on 21 December. There they could tell the tragedy of the two regiments in the Schnee Eifel.

During its first engagement, the 106th Infantry Division lost 60% of its strength with 416 killed, 1246 wounded and 7001 missing (the majority captured). This was the biggest disaster of the US Army during the European campaign in 44/45. Nevertheless, it did consume time and contributed, like so many other units, to slow down German units during the crucial first days of the Ardennes offensive.